

BC Insights Dashboard Setup Guide

A beginner-friendly guide for installing the required tools, downloading the dashboard from GitHub, and running it on a personal computer.

What this guide does

This guide helps a non-technical user run the dashboard on their own computer. The dashboard will run locally, which means it opens in the browser using localhost and does not publish the dashboard publicly.

Before You Start

You need three things: Python, Git, and a terminal application. On Windows, the terminal can be Command Prompt or PowerShell. The steps below use Command Prompt because it is simple for beginners.

Important

Do not double-click the dashboard HTML file directly. Some pages need the local server. Always start the server first, then open the localhost link in your browser.

1. Install Python

1. Open this website: <https://www.python.org/downloads/>
2. Click Download Python.
3. Open the downloaded installer.
4. Before clicking install, check the box that says Add Python to PATH. This is very important.
5. Click Install Now and wait until the installation is complete.

To check that Python is installed:

1. Open the Windows Start Menu.
2. Search for Command Prompt and open it.
3. Type this command and press Enter:

```
python --version
```

If you see something like Python 3.12.x or Python 3.13.x, Python is ready.

2. Install Git

1. Open this website: <https://git-scm.com/downloads>
2. Download Git for Windows.
3. Open the installer.

4. Keep the default options and click Next until installation starts.

5. Finish the installation.

To check that Git is installed, open Command Prompt and run:

```
git --version
```

If you see something like git version 2.x.x, Git is ready.

3. Download The Dashboard From GitHub

Open Command Prompt and go to the folder where you want to save the dashboard. For example, to use your Documents folder:

```
cd Documents
```

Then download the dashboard repository:

```
git clone https://github.com/mehdi-naji/BCLS.git
```

After the download is complete, enter the project folder:

```
cd BCLS
```

If the clone command does not work

The repository may require GitHub access. Ask the dashboard owner for access, or open the GitHub page and copy the repository clone URL. The SSH remote used by the project is: `git@github.com:mehdi-naji/BCLS.git`

4. Run The Dashboard

Inside the project folder, run this command:

```
python scripts/serve.py
```

Keep this Command Prompt window open. It is running the local dashboard server.

Do not close this window

If you close the Command Prompt window, the local server stops and the dashboard may stop working.

5. Open The Dashboard

Open your web browser and go to this address:

```
http://localhost:8080/dashboards/bc_dashboard_hub/html/dashboard.html
```

The dashboard should now open on your computer.

6. How To Stop The Dashboard

1. Go back to the Command Prompt window where the server is running.
2. Press Ctrl + C.

This stops the local server.

7. How To Open It Again Later

You do not need to install Python or Git again. Just open Command Prompt and go back to the project folder:

```
cd Documents\BCLS
```

Then start the local server again:

```
python scripts/serve.py
```

Finally, open this link in your browser:

```
http://localhost:8080/dashboards/bc_dashboard_hub/html/dashboard.html
```

Quick Troubleshooting

Problem	What to try
Python is not recognized	Reinstall Python and make sure Add Python to PATH is checked.

Git is not recognized	Restart Command Prompt after installing Git, or reinstall Git with default options.
The dashboard page is blank or data does not load	Make sure you started the server with python scripts/serve.py and opened the localhost link, not the HTML file directly.
Port 8080 is already in use	Close other Command Prompt windows running the dashboard, then try again.

Final reminder: always start the local server first, then open the localhost dashboard link.